

How we reach farmers — cost & approach

Three ways to put Agri-Dosth in farmers' hands, side by side. All figures in ₹ (INR), for a small supervised pilot (~100–500 farmers), current as of July 2026.

	In-Built Chat Box  LIVE NOW • what we built	WhatsApp — Official API RECOMMENDED FOR SCALE	WhatsApp — Baileys X TRIED • NOT VIABLE
The approach	Our own web chat page. Farmer scans a QR / opens a link and chats in the browser.	Meta's official Cloud API (direct, or via a BSP like 360dialog). Sanctioned automation.	Un-official WhatsApp Web automation (reverse-engineered).
How farmers reach it	Scan QR / tap a link (browser). One tap of friction.	Message a WhatsApp number — where farmers already are. Lowest friction.	Same as official, but the number keeps dropping.
Server / hosting	₹500–1,000/mo The VPS you already run.	₹500–1,000/mo Same VPS + a public webhook.	₹500–1,000/mo Same VPS.
WhatsApp / messaging	₹0 No per-message cost — it's not WhatsApp.	₹0 now, then ~₹0.115/msg Replies within the 24-hr window are free until 30 Sep 2026, billable after. BSP platform fee ~₹1,000–2,000/mo (₹0 if direct to Meta).	₹0 Free — but see reliability.
AI (OpenAI) usage	~₹250–850/mo gpt-4o-mini — text + photo. Same for all three.	~₹250–850/mo	~₹250–850/mo
Reliability / ban risk	Rock-solid No bans possible. 24/7.	Rock-solid Official & sanctioned. No bans.	Gets banned The number was logged out repeatedly — proven not viable.
Setup time	Live today	Days	Unstable

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		Meta business verification. Or ~15 min via a BSP sandbox to start.	Instant, but breaks within minutes.
Est. total / month	₹750–1,850 Server + AI. That's it.	₹1,500–3,500 Server + AI + (optional) BSP fee + messaging after Oct 2026.	₹750–1,850 Cheap, but unusable.
Best for	Proving value now with zero risk & near-zero cost.	Real reach on the channel farmers already use, at scale.	—

The plan in one line: run the **In-Built Chat Box** now (live, ~₹1,000/mo, no risk) to prove farmers love Agri-Dosth → start Meta verification in parallel → move to the **Official WhatsApp API** for scale once approved.

- **Assumptions:** small supervised pilot (~100–500 farmers, a few messages each). AI cost scales with usage; heavy photo use pushes it higher.
- **WhatsApp pricing note:** Meta moved to per-message billing (Jul 2025); service replies inside the 24-hr window are free until **30 Sep 2026**, then ~₹0.115/msg. India rates, reconfirm before committing.
- **GST (18%)** applies on WhatsApp/BSP charges in India.